

something that has become a hallmark of sorts for the series. Also the abilities to side with factions and guilds by doing quests for them and gaining reputation, also began with Daggerfall.

This is also the first Elder Scroll game to have readable books in them, with lore, legend, humour, and song. This trend would continue in the following Elder Scroll titles. Well, the main story was more of you needing to save the Emperor who was in a pickle again (as usual, Emperor's these days we tell you).

The Elder Scrolls III **MORROWIND**

This is it guys, the title that made Bethesda the king of the RPG genre, The Elder Scrolls III: Morrowind. If you recall, we mentioned that the second TES game was going to be set in Morrowind, well they were already planning this game back in 1996, but the technological limitations of the time meant they would keep it in the back-seat for the time being. But after about 2 years, Todd Howard took up the project in 1998 and it was decided that the game would be powered by the Direct3D engine.

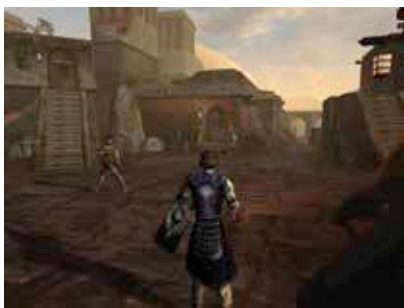
Morrowind would release a good six years after its predecessor – in the Summer of 2002 – giving Bethesda ample amount of time to work on it. During its planning phase the team wanted to have Morrowind be at around the same size and scale as Daggerfall, with all of Morrowind as the playing field. But it was later changed to instead focus on a smaller area instead, which was actually a good move on their part. The smaller area ended up having much more detail and work done on it. Despite being much smaller in scale, the game was

still dense with things to do. Bethesda is known for taking fan criticism seriously, and when they complained that the 750,000 NPCs in Daggerfall all felt dull and emotionless, they worked on that in Morrowind, they worked on ironing out everything.

The Elder Scrolls team, which had significantly more members now thanks to Bethesda, would go on to create The Elder Scrolls Construction Set, which would enable them to easily fix bugs and add content and expansions to the game. The construction set also made it easier for players to do the same, making Morrowind the first Elder Scrolls game to embrace modding. There's well over 3000 mods for Morrowind as of right now. This was also the first Elder Scroll to feature Orcs as a playable race.

Morrowind was very well received by the masses, with praises being showered on its visuals and the freedom that players were given. It would also maintain the same skill leveling system used in Daggerfall.

In Morrowind you were once again a prisoner tasked by the Emperor with defeating a dark lord in some volcanic wasteland. Did we tell you about these emperors? We did? Okay. Well, maybe it sounds dry here, but it's backed up by some amazing writing, making it a very enjoyable experience. Who knows, you may give it a shot even now and enjoy it.



The Elder Scrolls IV **OBLIVION**

The Elder Scrolls IV: Oblivion would release four years after Morrowind, in 2006, and is most probably the first Elder Scroll game for many of us. Work on the sequel – Oblivion – had begun in 2002 itself, right after Morrowind's release. While Oblivion was originally planned to release two years after Morrowind but was instead pushed to four years later, which meant that Oblivion would also have to keep next-gen consoles in mind upon release. Keep in mind the next-gen consoles we're speaking of didn't even exist at the time! The team got hardware details only within the last six months or so of development.

The now beefy Elder Scrolls team was split into two after Morrowind, one team to work on Expansions for Morrowind, and the other, primarily the programmers, to work on Oblivion.

Oblivion is first Elder Scrolls game to be fully voiced, there were also many graphical improvements made to the game, and use of a new AI system to make the NPC seem more alive, follow a daily schedule, move about in the city and whatnot. The combat was also improved, not relying as much on the 'dice roll' system. Again, Bethesda tackled issues players had in previous titles. They made the journal easier to use; Morrowind was often confusing for players who wouldn't know where to go next.

They also incorporated a level scaling system so that you could truly go in whatever direction you pleased. Enemies were meant to scale with you but this did have certain side effects like certain creatures completely disappearing if you out-scaled them, and ridiculously expensive items on the most unexpected people. There also came abusing of the skill system, where people could have a low character level but have certain skills at high levels to make the game a breeze, making it so the game could actually be harder for a higher level character than a lower leveled one.

Oblivion is also the first Elder Scroll game to have DLC. The 2\$ Horse Armor DLC is considered still the bout of many a joke by DLC critics. But